foxes eat rabbits but rabbits never eat foxes. Although there were earlier notions of a hierarchy of animals linked to each other in a food chain, British naturalist Richard Bradley brought more detail to this idea in his book *New Improvements in Planting and Gardening* (1718). He noted that each plant had its own particular set of insects that lived off it and proposed that the insects in turn received the attentions of other organisms of “lesser rank” that fed on them. In this way, he believed that all animals relied upon each other in a self-perpetuating chain.